

Mongolian saiga

Saiga mongolica



The saiga is unmistakable. The males of this “goat-antelope” have pointed, ringed horns that are waxy and translucent. Both sexes sport long, drooping nostrils. The fleshy proboscis contains convoluted air passages lined with hairs. In summer, the hairs filter out dust that blows across the steppes. In winter, the long nasal passages warm the air before it reaches the lungs.

Saiga gather in huge herds and spend the winter—which is also the mating season—in the south of their range to avoid the worst of the weather.

↔ 3–5 ft (1–1.4 m)

⚖ 57–152 lb (26–69 kg)

⊗ Critically endangered

🌿 Grasses, herbs, shrubs

🏠 🌞



C. Asia

Due to **human activity**, only **750 Mongolian saigas** remain in the wild



▷ **GRAZING MALE**
Saiga graze in the morning and afternoon—often traveling up to 50 miles (80 km) a day—and spend the middle of the day resting to aid digestion. As night falls, they scrape a shallow hollow to sleep in.



◁ **POINTED HUMPS**
Bactrian camels have erect humps that are much more pointed than those of feral and domesticated camels.



▽ **DESERT CROSSING**
Domesticated Bactrian camels are used for transportation in cold regions from China to Turkey. They are shorter and more well-built than the wild camels.